Lesson 1

HISTORY AND CONCEPT OF EXTENSION EDUCATION

1.1 Introduction

It is said that Rome was not built in a day. Similarly, Extension was not master-minded by one individual; rather it evolved through hard work of extension professionals around the world over more than a century.

The roots of extension education, however, can be traced back to 1840 when the term University Extension was first used in Britain to take the knowledge to doorsteps of common people. The first practical steps were taken in 1867-68, when James Stuart, fellow of Trinity College, Cambridge, England gave lectures to womens associations and working mens club. James Stuart is called as the father of University Extension. He approached the authorities of University of Cambridge to organise extension lectures. The system was accepted by the Cambridge as well as Oxford University in 1873. Dr. J. P. Leagans of USA is known as the father of extension, whereas Dr. K. N. Singh is known as father of Extension in the Indian context.

1.4 Definitions of Extension and Extension Education

Dairy Extension Education is a complex term which includes dairy, extension and education; so it is necessary to understand the meaning of each word as defined by various authors.

1.4.1 Extension

i. The word Extension is derived from the Latin roots: *ex* meaning out; and, *tensio* meaning stretching.

ii. Literally it means 'stretching out'. That is stretching out beyond the boundaries of university and research stations to reach the rural people to educate them on various issues.

iii. There is no single definition, some of the definitions include:

iv. Extension is an informal educational process directed toward the rural population. This process offers advice and information to help them solve their problems. Extension also aims to increase the efficiency of the family farm, increase production and generally increase the standard of living of the farm family.

v. Agricultural Extension is the application of scientific research and new knowledge to agriculture through farmer education. Agriculture extension implies all the activities that facilitate access of farmers, their groups, organizations and other market actors to Knowledge, Information and

Technologies. It facilitates farmers' interactions with other stakeholders such as researchers, training institutions, agri-business companies, and other relevant organizations.

vi. The objective of extension is to change farmers' outlook toward their difficulties. Extension is concerned not just with physical and economic achievements but also with the development of the rural people themselves. Extension agents, therefore, discuss matters with the rural people, help them to gain a clearer insight into their problems and also to decide how to overcome these problems.

vii. Extension is a process of working with rural people in order to improve their livelihoods. This involves helping farmers to improve the productivity of their agriculture and also developing their abilities to direct their own future development.

viii. Extension, or "advisory" services as it is known in Europe, is a non-formal adult educational function provided by institutions, typically public, private, donor-funded or voluntary, to disseminate information, training, and advice to a specific audience or beneficiary group.

ix. Extension refers to the actual work done by professional extension agents at various levels of management; while Extension Education refers to the body of knowledge concerning that work or practice.

x. Extension involves the conscious use of communication of information to help people form sound opinions and make good decisions

xi. Extension is everything that people who think of themselves as extensionists do as part of their professional practice

1.4.2 Extension education

1. Extension Education is a science, which deals with the creation, transmission & application of knowledge designed to bring about planned changes in the behaviour-complex of people, with a view to help them live better by learning the ways of improving their vocations, enterprises & institutions.

2. Extension Education is a science that brings about desirable changes in the behaviour of the concerned persons through educational methods, so as to improve their general standard of living with their own efforts. In fact, it deals with the designs & strategies of transfer of technology to the concerned persons. In other words, what is taught to the farmers is not Extension Education, though its knowledge is applied for the effective & efficient communication of various programmes of change.

3. Extension Education is the process of teaching rural people how to live better by learning ways to improve their farm, home and community institutions.

4. Extension as an out of school education and services for the members of the farm family and others directly or indirectly engaged in farm production to enable them to adopt improved practices in production, management, conservation and marketing. Several authors defined extension in various ways emphasizing the importance of one or the other aspect of extension.

1.1 Why extension is important?

Extension is essentially the means by which new knowledge and ideas are introduced into rural areas in order to bring about change and improve the lives of farmers and their families. Extension, therefore, is of critical importance. Without agricultural extension, farmers would lack access to the support and services required to improve their agriculture and other productive activities. The critical importance of extension can be understood better if its three main elements are considered:

Knowledge⇔ Communication ⇔ Farm Family

1.2. What is the meaning of extension?

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1.3. What is the objective of extension?

The objective of extension is to change farmers' outlook toward their difficulties. Extension is concerned not just with physical and economic achievements but also with the development of the rural people themselves. Extension agents, therefore, discuss matters with the rural people; help them to gain a clearer insight into their problems and to decide how to overcome these problems.

1.4. Principles of extension

- Extension works with people, not for them
- Extension is accountable to its clients
- Extension is a two-way link
- Extension works with different target groups
- Extension cooperates with other rural development organizations
- Equitable Services delivery to farmers
- Efficient/Effective Services Delivery

- Decentralization, Local Decision Making
- Demand Led Extension Services
- Working primarily with Farmers Groups
- Strong Extension Research Linkage and Extension Personnel
- Appropriate Extension Methodology
- Coordinated Agric. Extension Services

1.5 Differences between Formal Education and Extension Education It may, however, be mentioned here that when Extension Education is put into action for educating the rural people, it does not remain formal education. In that sense, there are several differences between the two. Some of these differences are:

Table 1.1 Differences between formal education and extension education

Formal Education	Extension Education
1. The teacher starts with theory & works up to practical.	1. The teacher (extension professional) starts with practical & may take up theory later on.
2. Students study subjects.	2. Clients study problems.
3. Students must adapt themselves to the fixed curriculum offered.	3. It has no fixed curriculum or course of study & the clients help to formulate the curriculum.
4. Authority rests with the teacher.	4. Authority rests with the clients.
5. Class attendance is compulsory.	5. Participation is voluntary.
6. Teacher instructs the students.	6. Teacher teaches & also learns from the clients.
7. Teaching is only through instructors.	7. Teaching is also through local leaders.
8. Teaching is mainly vertical.	8. Teaching is mainly horizontal.
9. The teacher has more or less homogeneous audience.	9. The teacher has a large & heterogeneous audience.
10. It is rigid.	10. It is flexible.
11. It has all pre-planned & pre-decided programmes.	11.It has freedom to develop programmes locally and they are based on the needs & expressed desires of the people.
12. It is more theoretical.	12. It is more practical & intended for immediate application in the solution of problems.

Lesson 2

OBJECTIVES, FUNCTIONS AND PHILOSOPHY OF EXTENSION EDUCATION

2.1 Introduction

The objectives of extension education are the expressions of the ends towards which our efforts are directed. In other words, an objective means a direction of movement. Before starting any programme, its objectives must be clearly stated, so that one knows where to go and what to be achieved.

2.2 Objectives

The dictionary meaning of objective is something that one's efforts or actions are intended to attain or accomplish; purpose; goal; target.

2.2.1 Fundamental objective

Fundamental objective of extension education is the overall development of the rural people

Agricultural extension in our country is primarily concerned with the following main objectives:

i. Dissemination of useful & practical information relating to agriculture, including improved seeds, fertilizers, implements, pesticides, improved cultural practices, dairying, poultry, fisheries, veterinary & animal husbandry, and food & nutrition.
ii. Practical application of useful knowledge to farm & home.
iii. . Improvement in all aspects of the life of the rural people within the framework of the national, economic & social policies involving the population as a whole.

2.2.2 General objectives of extension

The following are the general objectives:

i. To assist people to discover and analyze their problems and identify their needs.
ii. To develop leadership among people and help them in organizing groups to solve their problems.
iii. To disseminate research information of economic and practical importance in a way people would be able to understand and use.
iv. To assist people in mobilizing and utilizing the resources which they have or need from outside.
v. To collect and transmit feedback information for solving management problems.

2.3 Functions of Extension

Keeping the objectives in view, the function of extension is to bring about desirable changes in human behaviour by means of education. Changes may be brought about in their knowledge, attitude, skill, understanding, goals, action and confidence.

2.3.1 Change in knowledge

Change in knowledge means change in what people know. For example, a farmer who does not know about conservation farming technology or effective way of animal disease prevention, may know it through participation in extension programme. Similarly, Extension Agent (EA) who does not know about Information Technology (IT), comes to know of it after attending a training programme.

2.3.2 Change in attitude

Change in attitude involves change in the feeling towards any object, person, and thing. For instance, the afore-said farmer developed a favourable attitude towards the conservation farming technology. Similarly, the EA developed a favourable attitude in the use of IT.

2.3.3 Change in skill

Change in skill is change in the technique of doing things. Quoting the afore-said example, the farmer learnt the technique of conservation technology which he did not know earlier. Similarly, the EA learnt the skill of using IT.

2.3.4 Change in understanding

Change in understanding means change in comprehension. For example, the afore-said farmer realized the importance of the milk processing (paneer making) and the extent to which it was economically profitable and desirable, in comparison to the selling of raw milk. Similarly, the EA understood the use of IT and the extent to which these would make extension work more effective.

2.3.5 Change in goal

Change in goal is the distance in any given direction one is expected to go during a given period of time. For example, the extent to which the farmer exposed to paneer making technology raised the goal in dairy farming, in terms of increasing milk yield of dairy animals. Similarly, the EA

set his goal of getting an improved practice adopted by the clients within a certain period of time by using IT.

2.3.6 Change in action

Change in action means change in the way of doing things. The farmer who did not know conservation farming earlier, now has started practicing it. Similarly, the EA who earlier did not use IT in extension programmes started using them.

2.3.7 Change in confidence

Change in confidence involves change in self-reliance and ability. The afore-said farmer felt sure that he has the ability of practicing conservation farming at his own level. Similarly, the EA developed faith on his ability to do better extension work. The development of confidence or self-reliance is the solid foundation for making progress.

To bring desirable change in behaviour is the crucial function of extension. The farmers though their own initiative, shall continuously seek means of improving their farm and farm families. The task is difficult because millions of farm families with little education, scattered in large areas with their own beliefs, values, attitudes, resources and constraints are pursuing diverse enterprises. For this purpose, the extension personnel shall continuously seek new information to make extension work more effective.



Fig. 2.1 Functions of extension education

2.4 Philosophy of Extension Education

Philosophy literally means love for wisdom. Philosophy refers to the investigations about life and its various components. It is, in fact, an integrated view on the right conduct or 'what ought to be'. Thus, a man's view of 'What is right to do' indicates the kind of person he is. Such views serve as motivation for action. They reflect foundations of man's activities and the laws that govern them. Why is it essential to know philosophy of extension? Since, philosophy is a system of values and beliefs, knowledge of philosophy may guide one's work. It can become a tool for improving practice and consistent work-behaviour. There would not be confusion or conflict about the ultimate aim and approach of work. In any profession, one's conduct is sum of personal values, experiences and life style. Thus, philosophy is a practical tool to provide rationale for decisions.

2.4.1 Genesis of philosophy

Philosophy owes its origin to the Greek words *'phileo'* meaning love and '*sophia*' meaning wisdom. Thus, it literally means love for wisdom. In the early phases of its growth, philosophy embraced all branches of knowledge. Later with growth of sciences, range of subject matter dealt

by it narrowed. However, philosophy concerns itself with the fundamental questions about human existence and its place in the world. The purpose of human life, its guiding values, forces of transformation, the way of knowing reality and deciding what is right, etc. are the concerns of philosophy. It is a special system of knowledge dealing with complex problems and question of life. The methods of inquiry in this case are indepth, logical, rigorous and holistic. Thus, philosophy is a system of knowledge with its own methods of inquiry to delve deep into the questions of human existence and laws in an integrated fashion.

Often people perceive philosophy as something abstract or vague. It is commonly held that philosophy is the preserve of learned people or philosophers. This is not true. If philosophy is an integrated view of life, every person needs values to decide what is right. Philosophy is interwoven in daily life. Those who believe in eat-drink-and-be-merry follow a materialistic view of life. Their activities are guided by it. There is a system of belief in every person's life. Thus, one's perception of the purpose of life, ways to achieve goals, relationship between various components of life, etc. becomes source-spring of all actions. The life styles and activities of people are good indicators of philosophy of life, even though people holding them may not consciously recognize so. So, everyone needs sets of values, perception of self and the world to make sense of life's purpose. Such perceptions can become motive for committed action. Thus, there is some link between philosophy and practice. There is, of course, need to consciously recognise the value systems to resolve contradictory situations, Philosophy, then, can become a working tool for improving practice.

The practical implication is that the philosophy of a particular discipline would furnish the principles or guidelines with which to shape or mould the programmes or activities relating to that discipline.